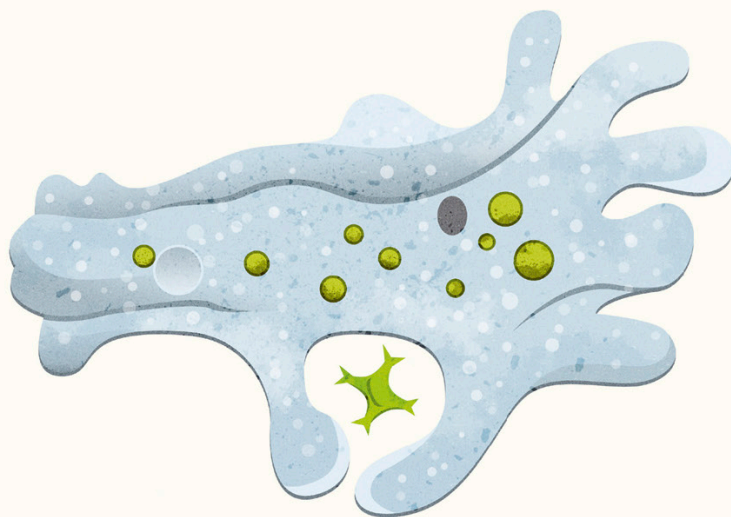


Amoeba

Like a tiny blob of jelly that has come to life, an amoeba (am-ee-ba) reaches out with wobbly legs to move. If you scoop pond water into a glass, you will probably catch a few amoebas. Each is made of a single cell, but big ones are just about visible to us. They have no brain, and to move, they simply change shape. First, they push out gloopy fingers, then the rest of their liquid body follows, so they flow like slime.

Just because amoebas are small, that does not make them gentle — they are as fierce as tigers! They flow right around their prey and fold themselves around it, digesting it alive. Luckily their dinner of choice is other microscopic life.



An amoeba can split in half to produce a pair of identical twin children.